

a study aid.

Guido realized that this arduous process could be made considerably simpler by employing mnemonics— assigning each note of the scale a name (associated with the melody of a hymn to John the Baptist that he composed specially for the purpose). He also visualized these names as if mapped on the joints of a hand, dramatically shortening the time it took to learn new chants, and devised a way of writing music as marks on the staff or stave (a system of parallel horizontal lines), indicating the precise pitch of each note.

Although these new techniques made learning and performing easier, many of the monks at Pomposa disliked Guido's innovation, and he left the abbey in about 1025. He returned to Arezzo, where the bishop appointed him as a teacher to the choristers of the cathedral, and commissioned him to write a treatise on the principles of his musical theories and to compile a collection of antiphons to present to Pope John XIX.

Guido completed his *Micrologus de disciplina artis musicae* (Treatise on the teaching of the art of music) in about 1026—it soon became the standard text for music theory and education in the Middle Ages. His reputation spread, and he was invited by the pope to Rome in 1028, but ill health restricted his activities until his death some five years later.